

Software Product Management English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: software product managers, product owners, UX leads, engineering managers, growth product teams, platform PMs, and product-operations staff

Focus: A software product-management English curriculum for discovery, roadmaps, user stories, prioritization, metrics, launches, stakeholder negotiation, experimentation, and product strategy.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Product Discovery and Problem Framing

Situation

A large customer asks for a custom feature.

Stakeholder pressure: Put it on the roadmap immediately.

Constraint: User need, segment fit, evidence, opportunity cost, and strategy need review.

Terms to use

- user need
- persona
- use case
- opportunity cost

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A large customer asks for a custom feature.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Put it on the roadmap immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects persona.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a discovery brief.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects persona.

Option	Phrase
A	user need
B	persona
C	use case
D	opportunity cost

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Put it on the roadmap immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify user need and persona against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A large customer asks for a custom feature. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discovery brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Module 2. Roadmaps and Prioritization

Situation

Executives want three major features in one quarter.

Stakeholder pressure: Commit to all three.

Constraint: Capacity, dependencies, risk, strategic fit, and sequencing must be clear.

Terms to use

- roadmap
- prioritization
- dependency
- capacity

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Executives want three major features in one quarter.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Commit to all three.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects prioritization.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a roadmap tradeoff memo.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects prioritization.

Option	Phrase
A	prioritization
B	dependency
C	capacity
D	roadmap

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Commit to all three.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify roadmap and prioritization against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	A roadmap tradeoff memo is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Executives want three major features in one quarter. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the roadmap tradeoff memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Module 3. User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

Situation

Design and engineering disagree about what done means.

Stakeholder pressure: Let engineering interpret the request.

Constraint: Acceptance criteria, edge cases, analytics, and UX intent need definition.

Terms to use

- user story
- acceptance criteria
- edge case

- definition of done

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Design and engineering disagree about what done means.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Let engineering interpret the request.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects acceptance criteria.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a user-story rewrite.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects acceptance criteria.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	user story

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Let engineering interpret the request.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify user story and acceptance criteria against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Design and engineering disagree about what done means. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the user-story rewrite with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	evidence threshold

Option	Phrase
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Module 4. Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics

Situation

Activation improved after a release.

Stakeholder pressure: Declare the feature successful.

Constraint: Cohorts, instrumentation, seasonality, and counter-metrics need review.

Terms to use

- activation
- retention
- funnel
- cohort

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Activation improved after a release.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Declare the feature successful.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects retention.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a metric interpretation note.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects retention.

Option	Phrase
A	activation
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	retention

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Declare the feature successful.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify activation and retention against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	A metric interpretation note is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Activation improved after a release. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the metric interpretation note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 5. Experimentation and A/B Testing

Situation

Marketing wants to launch a variant because early clicks are higher.

Stakeholder pressure: Roll it out to everyone.

Constraint: Sample size, significance, novelty effect, and guardrail metrics matter.

Terms to use

- A/B test
- hypothesis
- guardrail metric
- statistical significance

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Marketing wants to launch a variant because early clicks are higher.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Roll it out to everyone.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects hypothesis.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a experiment readout.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects hypothesis.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	hypothesis
C	guardrail metric
D	A/B test

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Roll it out to everyone.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve A/B test after the result is visible.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify A/B test and hypothesis against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Marketing wants to launch a variant because early clicks are higher. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the experiment readout with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	evidence threshold

Module 6. Release Readiness and Go-to-Market

Situation

A feature is code-complete but docs and support training are not ready.

Stakeholder pressure: Launch because engineering is done.

Constraint: Documentation, enablement, migration, monitoring, and rollback need readiness.

Terms to use

- release
- rollback
- enablement

- migration

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A feature is code-complete but docs and support training are not ready.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Launch because engineering is done.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects rollback.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a launch readiness checklist.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects rollback.

Option	Phrase
A	qualify
B	escalate
C	release
D	verify

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Launch because engineering is done.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify release and rollback against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve release after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A feature is code-complete but docs and support training are not ready. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the launch readiness checklist with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	evidence threshold

Option	Phrase
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Module 7. Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt

Situation

Engineering asks for a sprint to address technical debt.

Stakeholder pressure: Reject it because customers cannot see it.

Constraint: Reliability, developer velocity, support burden, and future roadmap risk need translation.

Terms to use

- technical debt
- API
- platform
- reliability

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Engineering asks for a sprint to address technical debt.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Reject it because customers cannot see it.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects API.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a technical debt business case.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects API.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	API
C	platform
D	technical debt

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Reject it because customers cannot see it.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve technical debt after the result is visible.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify technical debt and API against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Engineering asks for a sprint to address technical debt. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the technical debt business case with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Module 8. Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative

Situation

A senior stakeholder wants a feature that conflicts with strategy.

Stakeholder pressure: Agree to keep the relationship positive.

Constraint: Strategic fit, customer segment, cost, and alternatives need a clear recommendation.

Terms to use

- stakeholder
- strategic fit
- tradeoff
- decision memo

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A senior stakeholder wants a feature that conflicts with strategy.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Agree to keep the relationship positive.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects strategic fit.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a stakeholder pushback script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects strategic fit.

Option	Phrase
A	tradeoff
B	decision memo
C	stakeholder
D	strategic fit

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Agree to keep the relationship positive.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify stakeholder and strategic fit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A senior stakeholder wants a feature that conflicts with strategy. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the stakeholder pushback script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Product Discovery and Problem Framing - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. user need	'user need' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Product Discovery and Problem Framing - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify user need and persona against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Product Discovery and Problem Framing - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discovery brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Roadmaps and Prioritization - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. roadmap	'roadmap' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Roadmaps and Prioritization - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify roadmap and prioritization against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Roadmaps and Prioritization - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the roadmap tradeoff memo with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. user story	'user story' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify user story and acceptance criteria against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the user-story rewrite with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. activation	'activation' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify activation and retention against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the metric interpretation note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Experimentation and A/B Testing - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. A/B test	'A/B test' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Experimentation and A/B Testing - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify A/B test and hypothesis against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Experimentation and A/B Testing - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the experiment readout with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Release Readiness and Go-to-Market - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. release	'release' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Release Readiness and Go-to-Market - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify release and rollback against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Release Readiness and Go-to-Market - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the launch readiness checklist with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. technical debt	'technical debt' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify technical debt and API against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the technical debt business case with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. stakeholder	'stakeholder' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify stakeholder and strategic fit against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the stakeholder pushback script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.